



05. Legislation

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Step 1 - Starting point

Question

No linked steps

Legislation

What is Legislation?

Legislation is the process of making or enacting laws, as well as the set of laws or legal rules that have been formally established by a governing body, such as a parliament or congress. This process typically involves drafting, debating, and voting on proposed laws, called "bills," which, if approved, become enforceable rules within a particular jurisdiction.

Legislation is essential for organizing society, establishing rights and responsibilities, regulating conduct, and providing a legal framework for resolving disputes. It can cover various areas like criminal law, civil rights, economic policy, health care, and environmental protection.

Legislation ETG should follow

- 1. US DOT Rule 14

Step 2

Step 2

Question

Parent step: 1

US DOT Rule 14

What is US DOT Rule 14

Overview of US DOT Rule 14.

Summary

US DOT Rule 14 (The United States Department of Transportation) ensures passengers have a clear right to refunds, timely information on significant schedule changes, and protection in cases of overbooking. Airlines and ticket agents are required to follow specific guidelines to protect passenger rights, ensuring passengers are informed and compensated when necessary.

Purpose

Protects passenger rights when airlines oversell flights or make significant schedule changes, including automatic refunds and compensation for denied boarding.

Applicability

Covers U.S. and foreign airlines for flights to, from, or within the United States.

US DOT Rule 14

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Step 3

Solution

Parent step: 2

Key Provisions of DOT Rule 14

1. Automatic Refunds

Refunds are required when:

- The flight is cancelled by the airline.
- The airline makes a significant change to the flight schedule.

Refund Timeline:

- Refunds must be processed within 7 business days for transactions through credit/debit cards and 20 days for cash or check purchases. The seven business day deadline starts running when the agent receives confirmation of the passenger's refund eligibility from the airline.

Additional Info:

- Airlines (including for codeshare and interline) are obligated to provide refunds if flights are cancelled.
- Business days are considered to be from Monday through Friday, excluding Federal holidays in the United States.

2. Definitions of affected flight

Cancelled Flight

- A flight that was published in a carrier's Computer Reservation System (CRS) at the time of the ticket sale, and not operated by the carrier.

Significant Change

Defined changes to the itinerary which include:

- Departure Change: Leaving 3+ hours earlier (domestic) or 6+ hours earlier (international) than originally scheduled.
- Arrival Delay: Arriving 3+ hours later (domestic) or 6+ hours later (international) than originally scheduled.
- Rerouting: Departure or arrival at an airport other than originally scheduled.
- Additional Stops (Stopover): Increased number of stops compared to the original itinerary.
- Downgrade in Service: Moved to a lower class of service.
- Impact on Passengers with Disabilities: Involving different connecting airports or changes to accessibility features on aircraft.

3. Entities Responsible for Refunds

- Airlines and Ticket Agents who act as merchants of record (entities listed on customer billing statements) are responsible for issuing refunds.
- Ticket Agents (as defined in 49 U.S.C. 40102(a)(45)): Includes any person or business that sells or arranges air transportation as a principal or on behalf of airlines.

4. Informing Customers of Refund Eligibility

- Notice Requirement: Airlines and ticket agents must inform customers of their right to a refund before offering any travel credit, vouchers, or alternative travel arrangements.

Sample notification to customers about their refund options before alternative arrangements are offered in the 1st Alternative template. ATTENTION, once you identify that the rule is applicable to use the correct template.

> Additional information (Redirect to airline)



NOTE: Additional information is not relevant to our travel agency, in such cases please redirect the customer to the airline.

5. Overselling and Denied Boarding (Involuntary and Voluntary)

Overbooking: Airlines may sell more seats than are available to account for no-shows.

Volunteer Process: Airlines must first seek volunteers to give up seats in exchange for compensation.

Involuntary Denied Boarding: If not enough passengers volunteer, airlines may deny boarding involuntarily but are required to provide compensation and protections for these passengers.

6. Compensation for Involuntary Denied Boarding

Compensation Levels: Based on the time delay and alternative travel arrangements provided to passengers.

Rights Notice: Passengers denied boarding involuntarily should be provided a written notice explaining their rights and the compensation they are entitled to.

Exceptions of the rule:

- Compensation may not be required if a passenger fails to meet check-in requirements or if there are security or safety concerns.
- Airlines aren't obligated to compensate for delays due to factors beyond their control, such as extreme weather or air traffic control issues. (FM)

Rule 14 also requires that airlines fully disclose their policies regarding denied boarding, including how volunteers are compensated and how the airline decides who will be denied boarding involuntarily.

This rule aims to make sure passengers are treated fairly and informed of their rights in cases of overbooking.

Step 4

Solution

[Parent step: 2](#)

Step-by-Step Guide: Identifying if a Schedule Change (SC) Type is Affected by the U.S. DOT Rule 14

The steps below are to be followed only in case we have a direct request by customer on US DOT regulation.

Manual handling task under SC WM

Step 1: Verify Airport Locations

- Check the Flight Itinerary: Review the flight details to identify if any of the following airports are located within the United States:

- Origin Airport (where the journey starts)
- Arrival Airport (final destination)
- Stopover Airport(s) (any intermediate stops)

Example: If a flight has a stopover in New York, this itinerary includes a U.S. airport, which would trigger U.S. DOT rules for consideration.

Step 2: Confirm the Schedule Change (SC) Duration

- For International Flights: Verify if the schedule change results in a delay or timing change of **5 hours or more from the original schedule**.
- For Domestic Flights: Verify if the schedule change results in a delay or timing change of **3 hours or more from the original schedule**.

*Example: A 7-hour delay on an international flight departing from Los Angeles **meets the criteria for the U.S. DOT rule**.*

Step 3: Apply U.S. DOT Rule

If the above criteria are met (U.S. airport involved + timing threshold), the U.S. DOT Rule applies.

Action:

- **Label the Case:** Select the type of schedule change and label the case as U.S. DOT.
Automated Evaluation: Systems like FLX (LHG), Tripstack, Amadeus NDCx, and Travelfusion will automatically check if there is a U.S. segment in the order. If so, the agent will receive a notification to confirm the labeling as "U.S. DOT" by selecting **Yes** or **No**.
The logic developed as below:
 - **"Trivial" or "No Schedule Change":** Will mark as non-US DOT
 - **"Minor" or "Force Majeure":** Will not mark anything and will leave it for agents to select
 - **"Major" or "Critical":** Will mark it as US DOT.

Set type

☐ TR – 0 min, ≤ 30 min, no MCT
☒ MI – ≥ 31 min, ≤ 5 hrs, no MCT
☐ MA – More than > 5 hrs, with valid option
☐ CR – MCT &/or No alternative from airline
☐ FM – Force Majeure
☐ NO – No schedule change

☒ Change order state


The trip contains segments with origins or destinations in the US

Does SC case comply with US DOT regulations?
☒ Yes
☐ No

Set type

Cancel

- **Check Airline Policy:** Review the airline's policy to determine the appropriate action and communicate the next steps to the customer.
- **Use the U.S. DOT Template:** Select and send the relevant U.S. DOT template, with refund options provided as the first choice.
- **Document Investigation:** Add clear and detailed notes in the case to document your findings and ensure transparency and consistency for future reference.

This process ensures the customer is fully informed of their rights under the U.S. DOT rule and that their case is handled efficiently.

What Happens When the Customer Selects a Refund After Labeling the Case as U.S. DOT?

If the customer [opts for a refund](#) in response to the case being tagged as U.S. DOT, the case will already be labeled appropriately in the "[Manual Handling Queue](#)" flow.

The U.S. DOT tag ensures that the case is automatically prioritized in the refund dashboard, facilitating faster processing in accordance with **U.S. DOT Rule 14**.

Chat, Phone, Email tasks

Step 1: Verify Airport Locations

- **Check the Flight Itinerary:** Review the flight details to identify if any of the following airports fall within the United States:
 - Origin Airport (where the journey starts)
 - Arrival Airport (final destination)
 - Stopover Airport(s) (any intermediate stops)

Example: *If a flight has a stopover in New York, this itinerary includes a U.S. airport.*

Step 2: Confirm the Schedule Change (SC) Duration

For International Flights: Check if the schedule change results in a delay or timing change of 6 hours or more from the original schedule.

For Domestic Flights: Check if the schedule change results in a delay or timing change of 3 hours or more from the original schedule.

Example: A 7-hour delay on an international flight departing from Los Angeles meets the criteria.

Step 3: Apply U.S. DOT Rule

If the above criteria are met (U.S. airport involved + timing threshold), the U.S. DOT Rule applies.

Action: Phase 0 - Check the airline policy and act accordingly while informing the customer on your actions. If applicable, use the relevant US DOT template (with refund option first one).

Add clear errand notes of your investigation.

Step 5

Solution

Parent step: 2

How it is going to affect our handling?

Phase 1 Overview

As part of the recent updates to meet regulatory and operational requirements, the following adjustments are being implemented in how we handle schedule changes:

1. **Revised Templates:** Schedule change notifications only for US market templates, which are being updated to align with new requirements, ensuring clarity and compliance.
2. **Refund Alternatives:** Refund options will now be presented as the first alternative in 1as Alternative templates to comply with customer rights requirements.
3. **Language Adjustment:** The language used for refund options will be adapted to a more neutral, generic tone for consistency across communications.
4. **Automated Handling (0-5 Hours):** Schedule changes affecting flights by 0-5 hours will be processed automatically using the normal routine of the Schedule Change Script flow in GDS. Further details on the script functionality are available [here](#).
5. **Manual Handling for Longer Schedule Changes / Changes Over 5 Hours:** Any schedule change exceeding 5 hours will require manual handling by agents.
 1. Agents will process these changes either within the Workmode (WM) or outside it, depending on the tool's capabilities (Outside WM: VI and multi-order scenarios).
 2. Note for Manual Processing: Agents should move the refund option to the top of the list when handling cases outside the WM.
6. **Priority Payout Processing:** Approved refunds will be prioritized and processed within 7 days following airline approval, meeting new compliance requirements for timely refunds ONLY for US DOT Rule-affected orders.

Step 6

Solution

Parent step: 2

Step-by-Step Guidelines for Identifying and Handling the SC Script Automation for US DOT in Amadeus and Sabre

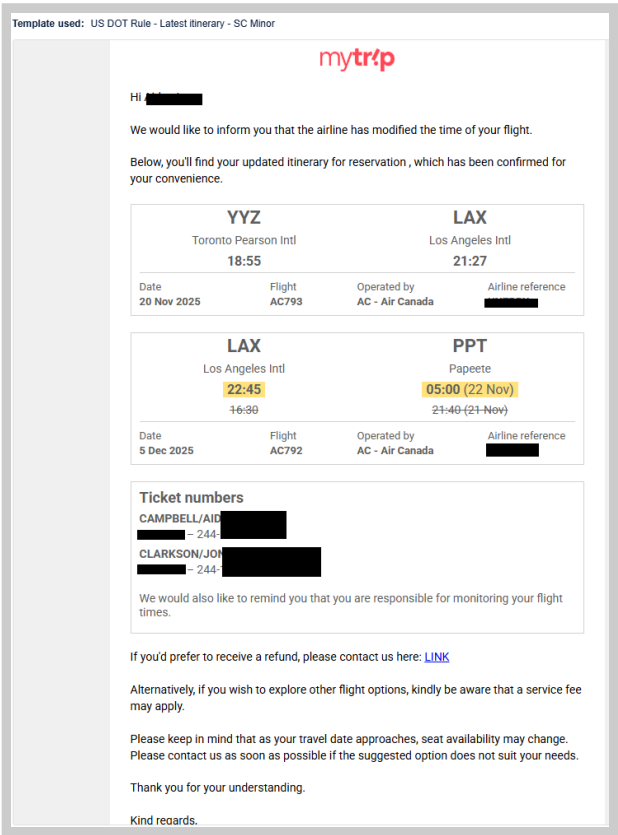
A new automation has been implemented in both **Amadeus** and **Sabre** based on the system-script configuration. This automation is designed to evaluate two specific conditions:

- Segments within the US
- Flight changes greater than 5 hours

Once these conditions are met, the automation will automatically perform a set of actions. Here’s what agents need to do to identify and manage this process:

Step 1: Automated SC Script Template Sent.

The automation will trigger the sending of a specific **SC script template for US DOT**. This template will include:



Refund Option with a link labeled **“Contact Us”** for any customer inquiries.

Step 2: Label the Case as "US DOT" in SC WM.

After the SC script template is sent, label the case as **"US DOT"** in the SC WM. This labeling ensures that the case is properly categorized and tracked according to the US Department of Transportation guidelines.

Step 3: Close the Case.

Once the case is labeled, proceed to close the case. This step marks the case as completed in the system:

The screenshot displays a support case management interface. At the top, there are tabs for 'Base/Bookings', '1/1 VAN:s', 'VAN for ticket reject', 'PNR:s', 'Payment transactions 1', and 'Support cases'. Below these, a row of buttons includes '2 Documents', 'Add on purchases 0', 'Send SMS', 'LCC', 'Manual VANs V2', 'Experimental', and 'Show All'. A green button labeled 'Order is on the queue' is visible. The main content area shows a case with a 'Label:' field containing 'US_DOT' (highlighted with a red box), an 'Announced:' timestamp of '2024-10-28 13:15' with a 'MI' tag, and a 'Source type:' of 'ENS'. The 'State:' field is set to 'CLOSED' (also highlighted with a red box). A 'Hide closed' toggle is at the top left of the case details. At the bottom, there are buttons for '+ Add new schedule change' and 'Open schedule change case'.

By following these steps, agents can easily identify when the automation has been triggered and take the appropriate actions to manage the case efficiently.

What if a customer requests a Refund after SC script automated handling?

If the customer replies asking for a refund in response to the 04. Schedule change GDS Automation (SC Script) flow, the case will already be tagged as **US DOT**. This ensures that the case is automatically prioritized in the refund Dashboard for faster processing.